DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 4

Excel expert

Profession 4 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An Excel expert builds and maintains spreadsheets for business: models, trackers and reports. The full skills are taught in the Data Analytics textbook; this chapter covers the admin use.

What professionals do every day

Builds trackers with validation drop-downs, summarises data with pivots, and automates repeated tasks with formulas and Power Query.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Teams run on spreadsheets. An expert makes them reliable, quick to read and easy to hand over.

- Spreadsheets nobody can maintain.
- Formulas that break when rows are added.
- Data entered in the wrong format.

Skills you need

- Formulas and lookups.
- Validation and tables.
- Pivot tables.
- Power Query basics.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
Google Sheets	Shared spreadsheets	Free	Paid plans	sheets.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a tracker with a validated status column.
Intermediate	Summarise with a pivot table.
Advanced	Replace a manual step with a formula.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Client tracker.
- **Intermediate:** Monthly expense sheet.
- **Advanced:** Stock list.

Client-ready portfolio project

A client tracker for a fictional firm: validated columns, a pivot summary and a one-page guide for the team.

Worked example

Worked example. A status column accepts only 'new', 'active' or 'closed' through a drop-down, so the pivot summary never shows a misspelt status.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Tracker with validated status

Business problem: A firm's tracker has statuses typed in many ways.

Steps

1. Create a drop-down with three allowed values.
2. Apply it to the whole status column.
3. Count rows by status with a pivot or COUNTIF.
4. Test by entering an invalid value.

Expected output: The tracker and a test showing the invalid value is blocked.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The drop-down stops invalid values at entry. A test with a wrong value confirms the rule works. Counts by status come from a pivot table, which updates when rows are added.

Common mistakes

- Hard-coded numbers inside formulas.
- Merged cells in data tables.
- No documentation.
- Uncontrolled copies of the same file.

Freelancing opportunities

- Tracker builds for small firms.
- Spreadsheet audits and clean-ups.
- Briefs for 'Excel expert', 'Excel dashboard', 'spreadsheet automation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Microsoft Excel help

Part of **Master Freelancing: Admin and Business Support**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.